

both versions of a design. The overall integrated experience is paramount in providing an easy and quick flow from design and validation in Multisim to final prototype with Ultiboard.

Installation

Double click on installation file in the DVD and unzip all the files; 537 files will be extracted. It will automatically open the file autorun.exe. Else you should do it manually. Click on 'Install NI Circuit Design Suite 13.0' and follow the steps indicated. Enter all the details and select the second option 'Install this product for evaluation.' Click Next. Choose the directory of installation and click on Next. You can select or deselect product notifications. Agree to both the agreements and click on Next. You will be prompted to install National Instruments ELVISmx software at the end of the installation. Click on Cancel and proceed. After the installation is complete, restart your computer before running any of this software. Post restart, launch the NI Launcher and use the required tool for your circuit designing needs.

You can extend the evaluation period from 7 days to 45 days, for which you will need an Internet connection. Double click NI Multisim 13.0; the tool prompts you information to extend the evaluation period. Click on Yes and proceed further. Fill in all your details and agree to the National Instruments privacy statement. In the next dialogue box, click on the link provided, copy the computer ID to clipboard and paste in the box on the website. Create your

System requirements

The following system requirements apply to all versions of NI Circuit Design Suite. To run NI Circuit Design Suite 13.0, your operating system must be one of:

- Windows XP, 32-bit edition
 - Windows Vista, 32-bit or 64-bit edition
 - Windows 7, 32-bit or 64-bit edition
 - Windows 8, 32-bit or 64-bit edition
 - Windows Server 2003 R2 (32-bit) or 2008 R2 (64-bit) edition
- NI Circuit Design Suite 13.0 does not support Windows NT/Me/98/95/2000, Windows XP x64, or the Windows Server non-R2 editions.

Your system must also meet or exceed the following:

- Pentium 4/M class microprocessor or equivalent
- 512MB of memory (256MB minimum)
- 2GB of free hard disk space
- SVGA resolution video adaptor with 800×600 video resolution minimum, 1024×768 or higher recommended

account at NI website if you do not have one. It is recommended that you create an account first, before extending the evaluation. After registering, you will get a 20-character evaluation code which needs to be pasted in the installation dialogue box. Restart the application and the evaluation period will be extended to 45 days. Perform the above steps for NI Ultiboard 13.0 to avail the same.

Top competing tools

Mentioned below are some other similar software tools:

KiCad. KiCad is an open source software suite for electronic design automation (EDA) for designing schematics of electronic circuits and printed circuit boards (PCBs).

TINA. TINA Design Suite is a powerful circuit simulation package for analysing, designing and real-time testing of analogue, digital, VHDL, MCU, SMPS, RF, communication,

optoelectronic and mixed electronic circuits and their PCB layouts.

EAGLE. EAGLE Layout Editor is an easy-to-use, yet powerful tool for designing printed circuit boards (PCBs). It has three main modules: Layout Editor, Schematic Editor and Auto Router.

Altium Designer. Altium Designer (currently, Winter '09 version) is an all-in-one software for PCB design. From schematic to PCB as well as FPGA programming, signal integrity check, mixed analogue/digital simulation, this software is what you need when it comes to PCB design.

Proteus PCB Design. It combines the ISIS schematic capture and ARES PCB layout programs to provide a powerful, integrated and easy-to-use suite of tools for professional PCB design. ●

The author is a senior technical correspondent at EFY. This article has inputs from white papers available at National Instruments website

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